serious enough to warrant the disposition of his rule and sovereignty in Kashmir. In post-independent India, in the 20th and 21st centuries respectively, the enemy in question is Pakistan by itself first and then later as a proxy for China. The political flirtation of successive Kashmiri politicians with separatists, propped up by Pakistan, has, time and again, resulted in the suspension of the democratic political process in Kashmir and in the declaration of the Governor's rule. Today, the threat to the state of Jammu and Kashmir is China, both directly and via its proxy, Pakistan. Indian forces have been engaged in confrontational military policies with the Chinese in the eastern parts of the state for almost two centuries now. Both in 1841 and later in 1962, Indian forces in Ladakh have been defeated by the Chinese, thanks to India's bad logistical tactics. History, unfortunately, tends to repeat itself.

The Government of India's perception of threat from Maharaja Pratap Singh's alleged communication with the Russians carried such gravitas that the dispossession of the Maharaja's rule was held for 16 long years. It was only with the humiliating defeat of Russia in 1905, in the hands of the Japanese Army, that Britain and Russia were persuaded of the need to resolve their differences in Asia. They engaged in talks and the Anglo-Russian Convention of 1907, or the Convention between the UK and Russia relating to Persia, Afghanistan and Tibet, was signed on 31 August 1907, in St Petersburg. The convention sought to remedy the shaky Russian-British relations by solidifying boundaries that identified each nation's respective control over Persia, Afghanistan and Tibet. The treaty delineated each country's influence in Persia and stipulated that neither country would interfere in Tibet's internal affairs. It also recognised Britain's influence over Afghanistan. It was only when these talks reached a determinate stage that the Government of India felt secure enough to restore the Maharaja's rule.[18]

Further Erosion of Pratap Singh's Powers